

gies hitting our roadmap today. Our team spent a lot of time with IDEO and learned a great deal about the unique way they drive innovation. They called their process "design thinking."

In a recent article about how Apple drives innovation, design thinking (or d.thinking) is described as "a systematic approach to problem solving that is user-driven, possibility focused and iterative." It is a process developed by leading design firms, now being taught by top universities, with methods borrowed by some of the most storied innovators in history, and is recognised by the industry as a proven process to identify practical, value-add solutions to complex problems. It is positioned as a process to use when a team is trying to figure out the "what" and "why" of their project based on the needs of their users. Naturally, there are skeptics who think it's overrated and there are those who over-hype it, describing it as a panacea that can solve every imaginable problem. It depends on how you apply it, but I can state from experience that if you do it right and commit to it, it's a great way to introduce innovation into a team or project.

INTEL® AND DESIGN THINKING

CYBERLINK AND INTEL® USE COLLABORATIVE DESIGN TO CREATE MEDIASTORY*

Cyberlink MediaStory (<http://dgit.in/1oUgoAH>) software greatly streamlines the process of organising and accessing the mountains of pictures and videos stored across phones, cameras, tablets, PCs and the cloud to assemble professional-looking videos that can be shared in minutes. The inspiration behind the idea was to help virtually anyone tell their personal stories quickly and easily. The two companies are known for their long history of collaboration in which Intel® has provided optimisations for Cyberlink applications to



Documentary trilogy on Design – *Helvetica, Objectified and Urbanized*

take advantage of the latest processor features. But this time, Intel® provided support from the very beginning till the end product was made touch optimised for Windows 8 by undergoing usability and focused group testing sessions.

THE STORY BEHIND MEDIASTORY

In creating MediaStory, CyberLink and Intel® approached the collaboration in a completely new way. "Complex video-editing solutions have been available for many years," Louis Chen, CyberLink's VP of Business Development, said. "We wanted a new user-centric approach to innovate in how we could bring the storytelling software to life." For two intense days in February 2013, executives from both companies along with a variety of stakeholders – engineers, product designers, user experience specialists and marketing people, among others – assembled at CyberLink's offices in Taipei to utilise the Design Thinking process to shape MediaStory. They interviewed end users to get a deeper understanding of their pain points and comfort zones, reviewed market data and brainstormed possible solutions to address and delight the target users' needs.

In the end, they zeroed in on a specific market need by first identifying a challenge: The explosion of mobile devices capable of producing great-looking photos and HD video was inundating consumers with too much content. As Chen put it, "We realised that people are overwhelmed with media. They want (need) to easily create great-looking photos and videos, and keep track of it all on whatever devices they have at hand." With that in mind, the two tech companies kicked into high gear.

Wanting to bring a solution to market as quickly as possible, they targeted a Q3 release date – which significantly shortened CyberLink's usual development cycle. The MediaStory design document was drawn up in less than two months, a process that normally takes 4-6 months. Taking MediaStory from idea to its first deployable iteration took just four months. "That was unprecedented for CyberLink," Chen said. During that time, iterative testing through numerous focus groups put the nascent software through its paces, and they shared their feedback with the design team so the team could further refine and add features.

You can read more about Chen's views on the challenges faced during the development of MediaStory at: <http://dgit.in/1lj4IqF>.

IN CREATING MEDIASTORY, CYBERLINK AND INTEL APPROACHED THE COLLABORATION IN A COMPLETELY NEW WAY. FOR TWO INTENSE DAYS A VARIETY OF STAKEHOLDERS ASSEMBLED AT CYBERLINK'S OFFICES TO UTILISE D.THINKING TO SHAPE MEDIASTORY.

EXTRAS:

1. Watch the 4-minute video at <http://dgit.in/1phmU3M> to understand how design thinking was used to tackle the problem of child obesity.
2. Also watch Gary Hustwit's design documentary trilogy, *Helvetica, Objectified and Urbanized*. ■